expression of human rights and dignity. Human rights, as enshrined in the major international instruments, are embodiments of basic rights of individuals, which they are entitled to enjoy as human beings. These are certain standards set to induce the states to respect the fundamental freedoms of their citizens. Apart from the UN Charter and the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR) of 1948, a host of other international instruments on human rights such as the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (ICESR) 1966, International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (ICCPR) 1966, the Convention on the Prevention and Punishment of Crime and Genocide (1948), the Convention relating to the Status of Stateless Persons (1954), the Convention on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination (1965), the Convention on the Elimination of Discrimination Against Women (1979), the Convention Against Torture and Other Cruel, Inhuman or Degrading Treatment of Punishment (1984), the Convention on the Rights of Child (1989) and others have been adopted. Certain regional instruments have also been adopted pertaining to human rights and fundamental freedoms, such as the European Convention of Protection of Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms (1950) and the American Convention on Human Rights (1981). These are nothing but exuberant and exotic expressions of the basic rights of individuals, which supposedly should be guaranteed by the states to their citizens. These constitute the **first and second generations** of human rights, which mainly aim at seeking economic, political and social rights for men by asking for or forbidding some kind of actions on the part of the state Parties to the treaties and conventions. Universal human rights are often expressed and guaranteed by law, in the form of treaties, customary international law, general principles, and other sources of international law. International human rights law lays down obligations of governments to act in certain ways or to refrain from certain acts, in order to promote and protect human rights and fundamental freedoms of individuals or groups.

A **third generation** of rights has come up for discussion pertaining to environment and sustainable development. This got expression in a number of efforts by world leaders and NGOs relating to